Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear five different people talking about going to famous places. For questions 1-5, choose from the list (A-H) what each speaker says about their visit to each site. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

A. Visitors are not permitted to walk inside the site.

B. We did not take enough water on our trip.

C. A very large animal tried to attack us.

D. Motor vehicles are not allowed to enter the site.

E. It was very expensive to enter the site.

F. We respected the wishes of the local people.

G. The guidebook I was carrying was very useful.

H. All the people we met or saw there were tourists.

Speaker 1 _____

Speaker 2 _____

Speaker 3 _____

Speaker 4 _____

Speaker 5 _____

Reading comprehension exercise

Leave only your footprints

Today's travellers have a range of responsible holiday choices. Aoife O'Riordain reports.

With the increasing awareness of global warming and the overuse of the Earth's natural resources, it would seem that the travelling public has never been so conscious of the effects and impact that their holidays have, not just on the environment but also on local communities the world over.

That said, Justin Francis, the co-founder of the website "Responsible Travel", still feels there is a long way to go so far as the public's awareness of green travel issues is concerned. Francis believes that although some consumers are now actively seeking out these types of holidays; the majority are still not aware of the growing number of choices. 'I wish that people were springing out of bed in the mornings thinking that they must select a holiday that does a better job of protecting environments and communities. Sadly, it does not happen, and the main factors are still the right experience, the right price and convenient departure schedules,' says Francis.

Despite a major airline's recent announcement that it plans to fly jets on fuel made from rubbish to shrink their carbon footprint, most people are aware that air travel is a controversial issue in the environmentally friendly travel debate. While many insist that the only truly green option is not to fly or to stay at home, those who still want to get away have an increasing number of choices available to help them lessen the environmental impact and give more to their host community.

The Green Traveller website promotes holidays that can be reached by land, as well as offering plenty of tips about having a greener holiday wherever you decide to go. Its managing director, Richard Hammond, agrees that interest in this kind of travel has grown. 'Very few holidays are 100 per cent green, so it's really about having a greener holiday. The most basic choice is looking at low-pollution forms of transport, or, if you are he going somewhere really distant, minimising your impact at the destination,' says Hammond.

While many of the properties it * features already have certification from a growing range of international and national schemes, Green Traveller's team of writers also personally assess each property and apply their own standards to the selection process, such as how waste is dealt with, to what extent local agricultural products are used, and whether visitors are encouraged to arrive by rail.

Older-established tour operators have also realised that a growing number of clients are beginning to Include this new set of factors when making their decision on where to holiday. Last year, First Choice added a Greener Holidays brochure into its programme, and tour operators now often list accommodation-only or activity-only prices so people can choose their own means of transport, such as travelling by rail rather than by air.

Hotels are increasingly keen to talk up their ecological achievements. One of the biggest criticisms of international hotel chains is their overuse of the Earth's resources, and in response many have implemented measures they claim it will

reduce this. While these are no doubt based on good environmental principles, schemes like planting a tree for every five towels reused, for instance, are unlikely to make much difference overall.

Francis believes that consumers are becoming more aware of such tokenism * from hotels and tour operators that may not have the best interests of the community or the planet true to their hearts. 'My real hope is that we get much more curious and more questioning, and 'there are rebellious tourists who see through this and ask increasingly tough questions' he says.

Find words and phrases in the text that mean the following.

1 people going somewhere
2 the days and times when particular flights leave
3 operate aircraft
4 go somewhere on holiday to have a rest
5 the place where you are going
6 firms that organise travel for people
7 thin book with photos that advertises something
8 transport not included
9 way of travelling

Answer the following questions.

What does Justin Francis say about attitudes to holidays?

A Everyone's top priority these days is to have greener holidays.
B Most people's reasons for choosing holidays remain the same.
C Tourists are only interested in finding the cheapest travel deals.
D Nowadays, more people who travel know about global warming.

Answer

What does the writer say about going on holiday by plane?

A A lot of people believe that it is harmful to the environment.
B Few people realise there is discussion about the harm it may do.
C There is no way of making it less harmful to the environment.
D The public think that new technology is making it harmless.

Answer

What does Richard Hammond suggest to people going a long way for their holiday?

A Take a train or a bus to get there instead of a plane.
B Do as little environmental damage as you can there.
C Make sure your holiday there is completely green.
D Look elsewhere for advice on greener holidays.

Answer

What does 'it *' refer to?

A the destination
B the team of writers
C the selection process
D the website

Answer

Some firms believe that people are now more likely to choose a holiday…

A which includes the cost of trave! in the price.
B in a place that serves food from that area.
C somewhere that produces no waste material.
D that is organised by a traditional travel company.

Answer

What is meant by 'tokenism *'?

A taking steps with the result that the problem is solved
B appearing to show concern but in practice doing very little
C setting a good example which others are now following
D doing as much as possible but without achieving success

Answer

****

Gapped text

For questions 1-8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (O).

Example: (O)- A declared B claimed C pretended D announced

CARNIVAL IN COLOMBIA

The Barranquilla Carnival, (O) .....B..... to be the biggest in the world after Rio's, is held annually on Colombia's Caribbean coast. For four days and nights, normal city life is (1) _____ by music and dancing, mixing European, African and Latin American influences in what is possibly the most culturally (2) _____ carnival on Earth.
Many thousands of people from all over the Caribbean (3) _____ there every February or March to enjoy an event that (4) _____ back to the 19th century. With them they bring a huge range of musical and dance styles, and some (5) _____ amazing costumes. Anyone (6) _____ with Barranquilla at that time will know how exciting the atmosphere can be. From the moment the mayor officially opens the Carnival, the action never stops, with events (7) _____ from colourful parades to lively street theatre. By night there are spectacular firework displays and many of the younger people seem (8) _____ of dancing round the clock.

1	A	ceased	B	suspended	C	cancelled	D interrupted
2	A	diverse	B	differing	C	disguised	D distinguished
3	A	join	B	concentrate	C	gather	D encounter
4	A	takes	B	dates	C	calls	D sends
5	A	slightly	B	extremely	C	very	D absolutely
6	A	familiar	B	informed	C	conscious	D- knowledgeable
7	A	ranging	B	spreading	C	stretching	D extending
8	A	skilled	B	capable	C	qualified	D expert

Writing – essay

Remember to use linking expressions such as:

Sequencing:

First of all,
In the first place,
For one thing
For another thing,
Next, in addition, what is more
On balance, to sum up,
Lastly,
To conclude,

More linking:

However, on the other hand...
Moreover,
Therefore,
Although, even though

TASK

In your English class you have been talking about the advantages and disadvantages of taking holidays near home rather than travelling abroad. Now, your English teacher has asked you to write an essay.

Write an essay using all the notes and give reasons for your point of view.

Is it better to have holidays near home rather than travel abroad?

Write about:

1) which is cheaper
2) which is better for the environment
3) your own extra idea

Write your essay in 140-190 word. You must use grammatically correct sentences with accurate spelling and punctuation in an appropriate e style.

Writing · essay: your answer (140-190 words)

Is it better to have holidays near home rather than travel abroad?

Grammar Reference

MODAL VERBS

1) Choose the correct option in these sentences

1 We could walk / could have walked, but it was hot so we decided to go by camel.
2 Aircraft mustn't / don't have to take off at night. It's against the law.
3 I can't find my ticket. I had to drop / might have dropped it on the platform.
4 You have to / must make less noise, children, while I'm driving.
5 You shouldn't / don't have to wear a seat belt on the train.
6 There may have been / must have been an accident, but it's more likely that roadworks caused the traffic jam.
7 I was at the airport by 6a.m. but I didn't need to get / needn't have got there so early because my flight was delayed.
8 The waves were huge and Mark realised he can't have / shouldn't have sailed his small yacht into the storm.

2) Say what the mistakes are in these sentences. Correct the mistakes.

1 So, before I took the bus to school, I must buy a new notebook.
2 I could find Juan's number and I phoned him the next day.
3 That day must have been a great day for us, but it was not.
4 We don't have to drive too fast, or do anything against the law.
5 We needn't to call you before we arrived because we knew that you were expecting us.
6 Bicycles are cheaper than cars, and you mustn't spend any money on petrol.
7 If there are a lot of people on the airport bus, you can have to stand all the way.
8 You might already heard that there is a robot that can clean floors.

3) Complete this phone conversation between two friends with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

Amy: Hi, I'm at the station but I can't see Stella. She (1) _____ (must / miss) the 9.15 train.

Lisa: Are you sure? It (2) _____ (could / get in) early, and she (3) _____ (might / leave) the station before you got there.

Amy: No, she (4) _____ (can't / do). I think I saw the 9.15 pulling out just as I arrived, and all the passengers getting off (5) _____ (have to / walk) past where I was standing, so I would've seen her.

Modal verbs · answers to exercise 1

1) Choose the correct option in these sentences

1. We could walk / could have walked, but it was hot so we decided to go by camel.
2. Aircraft mustn't / don't have to take off at night. It's against the law.
3. I can't find my ticket. I had to drop / might have dropped it on the platform.
4. You have to / must make less noise, children, while I'm driving.
5. You shouldn't / don't have to wear a seat belt on the train.
6. There may have been / must have been an accident, but it's more likely that roadworks...
7. I didn't need to get / needn't have got there so early because my flight was delayed.
8. Mark realised he can't have / shouldn't have sailed his small yacht into the storm.

Lisa: Have you tried phoning her?

Amy: Yes, but there's no reply. She (6) _____ (must / switch off) her phone, or she (7) _____ (might / even / forget) to take it with her.

Lisa: Hang on, I've just had a text from her, saying she's sorry but she fell asleep on the train.

Amy: She (8) _____ (must / have) a very late-night last night!

4) Use the correct form of the modal in brackets to reply to these comments. More than one answer is possible, and in some cases negative forms are needed.

1- That girl looks exactly like her sister. (must)

2- I felt really sleepy this morning. (should).

3- At my school, it was compulsory to wear a uniform. (have to)

4- I left my bike in the street and now it's gone. (must).

5- I took the train as I didn't know the bus was so cheap. (could)

6- I sometimes go horse riding without wearing a helmet. (should)

7- I've just seen the Prime Minister waiting at the bus stop. (can)

8- I'm sure I had some money on me, but I can't find it. (might)